Employee Promotion Shortlisting Policy

TEST FIXTURE ONLY | Policy TEST-HR-001 | Version 1.0
Effective: 8 November 2026 | Review cycle: FY2026

This fictional policy is designed to test spreadsheet and PDF retrieval in an application. It is not an adopted employment policy. A shortlist result is an invitation for human review, not approval of a promotion.

1. Scope and required evidence

Apply this policy to the **Performance Grades** worksheet. Use **Employee ID** as the employee identifier, **Full Name** as the display name, and **FY2025 Grade** and **FY2026 Grade** as the two consecutive review ratings. FY2024 Grade is historical context only and does not determine the FY2026 shortlist.

2. Promotion shortlisting rule

R1 - Shortlisted: An employee with a valid record is shortlisted when both FY2025 Grade and FY2026 Grade are **B or above**. The grade order is A (highest), B, C, D, E (lowest). Therefore, two consecutive Grade B ratings qualify. A/A, A/B, and B/A also qualify.

R2 - Not shortlisted: If both required grades are valid and either is C, D, or E, the employee is not shortlisted for this cycle. An earlier qualifying pair in FY2024 and FY2025 does not override a lower FY2026 rating.

R3 - Manual review required: If either required grade is missing or invalid, or Employee ID is missing or duplicated, classify the record as Manual review required. R3 takes precedence over R1 and R2. Do not treat missing grades as low performance.

3. Grade normalization and exclusions

Trim leading and trailing whitespace and convert grade text to uppercase before comparison. Only exact values A, B, C, D, and E are valid. Blank values, N/A, numbers, B+, and B- require manual review; do not infer their meaning. Employee IDs must be nonblank after trimming and unique within the worksheet.

This test policy has no tenure, salary, job-grade, headcount, or manager-approval threshold for shortlisting. Do not add criteria from Age, Gender, HR Remarks, or other unrelated fields. If other policy documents conflict with these rules, request clarification before producing a final classification.

Evaluation & Test Cases

TEST-HR-001 | Expected behavior for the FY2026 review cycle

4. Evaluation procedure and output

Evaluate every uploaded employee record, not only preview rows. First check R3 data quality, then apply R1 or R2. If a required column is absent, request the correct file or an explicit column mapping; do not substitute a numeric Performance Rating field from another file.

Return Employee ID, Full Name, FY2025 Grade, FY2026 Grade, Promotion Status, and Reason. Valid status labels are **Shortlisted**, **Not shortlisted**, and **Manual review required**. Include the applied rule ID in Reason and cite this policy with the relevant PDF page. When asked only for shortlisted employees, filter to Shortlisted and state whether any records need manual review.

5. Acceptance examples

Unless noted otherwise, each example has a unique, nonblank Employee ID. These examples are synthetic and are not employee records.

FY2025	FY2026	Expected status	Rule / explanation
B	B	Shortlisted	R1: two consecutive Grade B ratings
A	B	Shortlisted	R1: both ratings are B or above
B	A	Shortlisted	R1: both ratings are B or above
A	A	Shortlisted	R1: both ratings exceed B
B	C	Not shortlisted	R2: latest rating is below B
C	B	Not shortlisted	R2: prior rating is below B
b	B	Shortlisted	R1: normalize case and whitespace
B	(blank)	Manual review required	R3: missing latest rating
B+	A	Manual review required	R3: B+ is not a valid grade
B	B	Manual review required	R3 if Employee ID is missing or duplicated

6. Suggested application questions

1. Using the promotion policy, list all employees shortlisted for FY2026 and explain the rule applied.
2. Classify every employee, including records requiring manual review.
3. Count shortlisted employees by Department.
4. Why does an employee with FY2024 B, FY2025 B, and FY2026 C not qualify?
5. Show employees whose records cannot be evaluated because of missing or invalid grades.

Expected answer to question 4: Not shortlisted under R2. Only FY2025 and FY2026 determine the FY2026 shortlist; FY2026 C is below B.